which the organisation in question was able to meet its the promised results, i.e., *objective*. Various agencies will have a diverse set of objectives and corresponding success indicators. Yet, at the end of the year every organisation will be able to compute its composite score for the past year.

3. RFD Process and Timelines

Beginning of the Year: At the beginning of each financial year, each organisation to prepare a RFD. And as per the priorities listed in the RFD, proposed activities and the corresponding success indicators to be approved. The RFDs draft has to be completed by 5th of March for feedback and finalised by 31st March every year – the final versions of all RFDs to be put on the websites by the 15th of April each year. The final RFD to take into account budget provisions and in particular the *Outcome Budget*. The RFDs to be drawn up in such manner that quarterly monitoring is possible.

During the Year: After six months, the Results-Framework as well as the achievements to be reviewed – the RFDs may be reviewed and the goals reset, taking into account the priorities at that point of time (this will enable to factor in unforeseen circumstances such as drought conditions, natural calamities or epidemics). Cabinet Secretariat to select about 24 RFDs using a stratified random sampling procedure to examine them.

End of the Year: At the end of the year, all RFDs to be reviewed, a report listing the achievements of their respective organisations against the agreed results in the prescribed format. This report is required to be finalised by the 1st of May each year. After scrutiny by the concerned administrative ministry/department, these results will be placed on the website by 1st of June each year.

The RFD is among the attempts by which government have been trying to bring in higher performance in its ministries/departments together with ‘transparency’, ‘accountability’ and ‘responsibility’. This is in the series of other such initiatives like ‘Outcome Budgeting’ and ‘Performance Budgeting’. The ‘Zero-Base Budgeting’ was a similar and first such initiative in this direction taken by the GoI in mid-1990s.